TGPSC Group I — Paper III, Unit I, Topic 3

Social Issues: Integrated Editable Student Master

Cycle 105 legal-currentness and option-position repair · 30 October 2026 · ORIGINAL PRACTICE, NOT OFFICIAL PYQs · NOT INDEPENDENTLY APPROVED.

This edition integrates the earlier analytical repair inside 20 original numbered concepts, retaining the original published PDF unchanged. Thirty original four-option MCQs and eight original mains answers appear once each. Claims and diagrams require further independent review.

Offline: Topic page · Original PDF · Integrated PDF.

Part A — Syllabus and scope

Official syllabus and chapter map

TGPSC Group-I, Notification 02/2024, Annexure II, Paper III, Unit I, Topic 3.

Social Issues: Poverty; Unemployment, Child Labour, Violence against Women; Regionalism; Communalism and Secularism; Corruption; Caste Conflicts, Problems of Agricultural Labour; Urbanization; Development and Displacement; Environmental Degradation; Sustainable Development; Population Explosion; Agrarian Distress; Migration.

Official clause	What a serious answer must cover	Detailed notes
Poverty	Monetary vs multidimensional; chronic vs transient; deprivation; MPI measurement; Telangana contrasts	Section 2
Unemployment	PLFS usual/CWS, LFPR/WPR/UR; youth, women, job quality, skill matching	Section 3
Child labour	2016 amendment; 6–14 education; economic drivers; migration, family-work exceptions	Section 4
Violence against women	Physical/economic/psychological harms; PWDVA 2005; POSH 2013; institutions	Section 5
Regionalism	Constitutional demands vs exclusion; 1956, 1969, 2014 Telangana milestones	Section 6
Communalism and secularism	Identity politics; Articles 14–16, 25–30; rights and accountability	Section 7
Corruption	Petty/grand/state capture; PCA 1988/2018; institutional design	Section 8
Caste conflicts	Graded inequality; dominant caste; atrocity law; land and local power	Section 9
Agricultural labour	Seasonal wages, landlessness, historical MGNREGA and the VB–G RAM G 2025 transition, gender, worker protection	Section 10
Urbanisation	Urban share vs population growth; primacy, informal housing, Musi	Section 11

Official clause	What a serious answer must cover	Detailed notes
Development and displacement	Physical/economic displacement; Cernea; 2013 land acquisition law	Section 12
Environmental degradation	Water, air, ecology, exposures, legal responsibilities and justice	Section 13
Sustainable development	Brundtland, SDGs, strong/weak sustainability, trade-offs	Section 14
Population explosion	TFR, demographic transition, momentum, ageing, rights	Section 15
Agrarian distress	Crop vs price risk, net margins, debt, tenant farmers, Telangana	Section 16
Migration	Circular vs permanent, portability, housing, wage protections	Section 17

Exam pattern: The official Paper III pattern gives approximately 200 words per 10-mark question. The student chapter contains original ~200–250-word models rather than unverified official past questions.

Part B — Quick revision

Quick revision — short, medium and high-intensity

90-second checklist

- **Poverty:** monetary / relative / MPI / chronic / transient. NITI 2022–23 MPI 11.28% is an *estimate*, not a 2026 survey.
- **Jobs:** UR = unemployed / labour force; LFPR = labour force / population; WPR = employed / population. Do not compare usual-status UR to monthly CWS without caveat.
- **Child labour:** amended law 2016; generally under-14 work prohibited with limited exceptions; ages 14–18 hazardous work prohibited; RTE 6–14.
- **Women:** PWDVA 2005 covers domestic protection; POSH 2013 workplace redressal; recorded offences ≠ prevalence.
- **Regionalism:** Gentlemen's Agreement 1956 → 1969 movement → Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act 2014 → Telangana formed 2 June 2014.
- **Communalism:** organised religious antagonism ≠ religious identity; Articles 14, 15, 16, 25–30.
- **Corruption:** PCA 1988 (amended 2018), Lokpal Act 2013; procurement audit and citizen appeal.
- **Caste:** Ambedkar graded inequality; Srinivas dominant caste; Article 17, PCR 1955, PoA 1989.
- **Agricultural labour:** distinguish the **historical** MGNREGA 2005 household guarantee (100 days) from the **current** VB–G RAM G Act 2025 (125 days per eligible rural household), effective **1 July 2026**; check actual work and wages, not statutory numbers alone.
- **City:** urban growth ≠ urbanisation; GHMC municipal vs HMDA metro planning; Musi is catchment issue.
- **Displacement:** physical vs economic; Cernea eight impoverishment risks; 2013 LARR law where applicable.
- **Environment:** exposure ≠ emission; environmental justice means unequal burden recognition.
- **Sustainability:** Brundtland 1987; 17 SDGs; present gains vs long-run water/heat/ecology.
- **Population:** TFR ≠ birth rate; population momentum; demographic dividend is conditional.
- **Agrarian distress:** yield, market, cost, credit and tenancy risks; farmer ≠ farm labourer.

- **Migration:** seasonal/circular vs permanent; portability, school continuity, safe housing.

5-minute conceptual map

- **Economic:** poverty, unemployment, agrarian distress, agricultural labour, migration.
- **Social power:** caste conflict, violence against women, child labour, communalism, corruption.
- **Spatial and ecological:** urbanisation, displacement, environmental degradation, sustainability.
- **Political and demographic:** regionalism, secularism, population transition.
- **Cross-link:** labour-market insecurity + discrimination + environmental shock → capability shortfall.

Answer-writing template (~200 words for 10 marks)

Opening (25 words): precise definition and thesis.
Mechanisms (90 words): 3–4 non-overlapping, causally explained drivers.
Distinctive evidence (45 words): named law/institution, dated datum where verified, Telangana illustration.
Evaluation (25 words): what the law or scheme cannot itself solve.
Conclusion (15 words): measurable and rights-consistent remedy.

Mistakes to avoid

- Giving a current year without its official reference period.
- Claiming all working children or all adolescent jobs are legally identical.
- Equating any religious difference with communalism.
- Treating Telangana's 2014 formation as proof all regional inequality ended.
- Treating land compensation as full rehabilitation.
- Mixing urban population size, urban share and administrative reclassification.
- Describing migration as invariably harmful or beneficial.
- Treating a programme announcement as a confirmed achieved outcome.

Part C — Twenty concepts and integrated analytical depth

1. How to study social issues: causes, institutions and consequences

A *social issue* is not simply an individual hardship. It is a persistent condition that affects a substantial group, is embedded in institutions or unequal power, and invites public deliberation or collective remedy. Poverty may be expressed through an undernourished person, yet its determinants include wages, land ownership, food prices, discrimination, public-service access and the distribution of unpaid work. Crime against women may involve an identifiable perpetrator but is also shaped by norms, reporting barriers, housing insecurity and failures of institutional response. Strong TGPSC answers therefore move beyond moral condemnation to explain **who is vulnerable, through what mechanism, and at which administrative level an intervention would work**.

Three conceptual lenses are useful. **Structural inequality** highlights unequal property, caste hierarchy, occupational segmentation and gendered authority. **Capabilities**, associated with Amartya Sen, ask what people are genuinely free to do and become, not only how much money they receive. **Social exclusion** identifies barriers that prevent people from converting legal rights into usable opportunities. These lenses are complementary: a cash transfer may reduce immediate hardship, while schools, secure tenure, safety and freedom from discrimination determine long-run capabilities. Finally, the **life-cycle and intersectional lens** shows that a migrant adolescent girl working in an informal enterprise faces overlapping age, gender, class and residential disadvantages.

For a 10-mark question, define the issue in one or two sentences; develop three or four **distinct causal mechanisms**, name the relevant constitutional or statutory instrument, provide one accurate national or Telangana example, then offer an intervention with an indicator by which it could be evaluated. A programme's name is never sufficient evidence of success. Distinguish a law's intention from its enforcement and a survey's result from a current administrative count.

Integrated analytical deepening — repair 1: A causal map: why social problems persist despite laws and schemes

A scheme can expand formal eligibility while an individual's effective access remains unchanged. Consider a landless family whose livelihood depends on farm labour. A delayed wage payment causes borrowing; interest and travel costs erode disposable income; a seasonal move interrupts schooling; a child begins unpaid production work; and missing residence documents complicate benefits at the destination. Each link crosses an administrative boundary. The labour department may see child work, the education department absenteeism, the rural-development office payment delays, and the urban local body insecure shelter. Treating the final symptom in isolation is expensive and often ineffective.

Three mechanisms should be separated in an answer. **Resource scarcity** means insufficient land, money, water, jobs or public services. **Institutional exclusion** means that resources exist but rules, discretion, identity documents, distance, discrimination or poor grievance procedures block access. **Risk transmission** means a temporary shock becomes permanent damage through debt, lost learning, asset sales or illness. The remedies differ: investment addresses scarcity; enforceable access and audits address exclusion; insurance, prompt payments and continuity of schooling address risk transmission. An administrator should identify the binding constraint before recommending another awareness campaign.

Use an explicit chain: *shock or unequal endowment → household coping response → institutional friction → cumulative deprivation → measurable outcome*. A policy is credible when it names both the agency responsible and the indicator that would show improvement. For instance, number of inspections is an output; sustained school retention after a child-labour rescue is closer to an outcome. Likewise, registration for a welfare scheme is not equivalent to receipt of timely benefits.

2. Poverty: monetary, multidimensional, relative and intergenerational

Absolute monetary poverty measures whether command over consumption or income is below a specified threshold; the result varies with the poverty line, prices, survey method and reference year. **Relative poverty** concerns disadvantage compared with prevailing social standards; it can coexist with rising average incomes. **Multidimensional poverty** assesses deprivations in health, education and living standards, recognising that a family with a marginally higher income can still lack sanitation, schooling or health access. **Transient poverty** results from a shock such as illness or crop failure, while **chronic poverty** persists when assets, opportunities and social power remain constrained.

The National Multidimensional Poverty Index uses a weighted deprivation method informed by Alkire-Foster measurement. Official estimates and projections must be labelled correctly: NITI Aayog's January 2024 discussion paper estimated an **11.28%** multidimensional-poverty headcount for **2022–23**, rather than supplying a directly enumerated 2026 poverty census. A student should not treat the figure as the current monetary poverty rate. At the household level, debt service, medical expenses, education cost, landlessness and gendered care responsibilities cause a **poverty trap**: low earnings prevent asset accumulation, and weak assets perpetuate low productivity. Poverty can be geographically clustered where irrigation, transport, schools and health facilities are inadequate.

Telangana examples should compare rural dryland households vulnerable to monsoon-related earnings volatility with low-income renters in Hyderabad who face high housing and commuting costs despite proximity to jobs. The policy design must join reliable employment, health protection, safe housing and education. **Historical versus current rural job law:** MGNREGA 2005 guaranteed at least **100 days per eligible rural household**, not per adult individual. The Union Government notified its repeal and the nationwide commencement of the **Viksit Bharat—Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB–G RAM G) Act, 2025** on **1 July 2026**; the replacement guarantees **125 days per eligible rural household**. A statutory guarantee is not evidence that a household actually received those days or timely wages. Beyond counting beneficiaries, measure timely wage payment, actual person-days, local asset durability, school attendance and the persistence of distress borrowing.

High-yield exam distinction: reduction in a national MPI estimate is important, but it neither disproves deprivation in particular communities nor measures inequality among all groups. Use the words *headcount, intensity, method, period and denominator* before quoting a percentage.

Integrated analytical deepening — repair 2: Poverty: measurement is a political and statistical choice, not a single number

An income or consumption poverty line asks whether command over goods and services crosses a specified threshold. A multidimensional index asks whether the same household experiences weighted deprivations in selected health, education and living-standard indicators. These are different constructs: a family can improve electricity access and sanitation while earnings remain precarious; another can have income above a line while a disabled family member lacks accessible transport or healthcare. Neither measure should be presented as a complete account of social justice. The relevant question is which deprivation is being measured, for which population and period.

The National MPI discussion paper released by NITI Aayog in January 2024 projected an 11.28% headcount for 2022–23. This figure is an **estimate based on extrapolation**, not a direct enumeration of households in 2022–23 and certainly not a 2026 census. The distinction matters in a mains answer: projections can be useful for trends but cannot settle local claims about landless workers, urban renters or tribal hamlets. Survey-based measures require attention to sampling, recall periods, price adjustment and the distinction between a national mean and district heterogeneity.

A Telangana district poverty strategy should classify households by livelihood and exposure, not only by an administrative below-poverty-line tag. Dryland cultivators need crop-risk management and viable market access;

agricultural labourers need predictable wage opportunities and portable entitlements; low-income Hyderabad tenants need affordable transport, rental stability and health protection. The common outcome is reduced **vulnerability to shocks**, measured through distress debt, consumption volatility, school continuity and avoidable medical expenditure. The limitation is that integrated case management requires data safeguards: a shared beneficiary database must not become an exclusionary gatekeeper when records disagree.

Cycle 103 source-bounded check

NITI evidence boundary (15 January 2024). The 11.28% national multidimensional-poverty headcount for 2022–23 was a projected estimate in NITI Aayog's discussion paper, not a 2026 household enumeration. Monetary poverty measures income or consumption shortfall; MPI combines weighted deprivations. Do not turn a projected national figure into a Telangana district rate. A sound district comparison requires comparable survey years, indicators and uncertainty.

3. Unemployment and underemployment: measurement before explanation

Open unemployment concerns people seeking or available for work but not employed under a specified survey definition. **Underemployment** covers people who work fewer hours or in lower-productivity activities than desired. **Disguised unemployment** is a textbook explanation for situations in which additional family workers contribute little marginal output, but it must not be assumed for every small farm. **Educated unemployment** reflects mismatch between qualifications, expectations and accessible vacancies. **Frictional** unemployment accompanies transitions, **structural** unemployment accompanies changes in skills or industry demand, and **cyclical** unemployment accompanies demand contraction.

India's Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) offers different concepts: *usual status* (principal and subsidiary economic activity over a longer reference period) and *current weekly status* (a seven-day reference frame). Their unemployment rates **cannot be directly substituted**. LFPR means labour-force participants relative to the population; WPR measures workers relative to the population; UR measures unemployed persons relative to the **labour force**, not the total population. Rising female LFPR must be interpreted alongside job quality, unpaid household work, own-account work and hours. The MoSPI annual PLFS 2025 report and its monthly 2026 bulletins have different reference periods; use the annual series for long-run comparisons and monthly CWS for recent short-run signals.

The regional employment problem is not only lack of vacancies. Hyderabad's pharma and IT clusters demand specialised skills and networks; rural graduates may face mobility costs, language requirements and incomplete information. At the same time, informal work may offer income without written contracts, predictable wages or protection. Remedies have to distinguish **job creation** (labour-intensive enterprises, infrastructure and value chains), **matching** (apprenticeships and placement), **capability** (foundational literacy and job-specific training), and **quality** (safety, security and social insurance). A state employment programme should be assessed by retention after six or twelve months, earnings progression and female participation, not just the number trained.

Mains trap: “unemployment rate fell” is not equivalent to “all jobs improved.” The latter claim requires hours, earnings, formality, productivity and occupational distribution.

Integrated analytical deepening — repair 3: Unemployment: distinguish inactivity, open joblessness and inadequate work

The unemployment rate uses the *labour force* as denominator. It cannot tell whether people outside the labour force are discouraged workers, full-time students, carers or others. Labour-force participation rate and worker-population ratio use population denominators; unemployment, participation and employment should therefore be read together. The Periodic Labour Force Survey distinguishes usual-status classifications from current-weekly status. Comparing a monthly CWS headline with a usual-status annual series as though they were identical creates a false trend. The annual PLFS 2025 report was published in 2026 and supplies state-level breakdowns; any quoted figure must state age group, sex, rural/urban category and reference definition.

Underemployment is not merely a smaller unemployment rate. An educated person delivering occasional services may be counted as working while experiencing unstable hours, weak bargaining power and no employment security. A woman who enters low-paid household-enterprise work may increase the participation measure without gaining control over earnings. A labour-market intervention must therefore distinguish **demand** (number of viable positions), **matching** (information and recruitment), **skills** (ability to perform tasks), **mobility** (transport, housing and safety) and **quality** (real earnings, hours, contracts and protection). Training alone cannot repair weak labour demand; a hiring subsidy cannot compensate for unsafe commuting; more jobs do not automatically resolve caste or gender discrimination.

A Telangana example is the contrast between Hyderabad's specialised technology and pharmaceutical occupations and seasonal agricultural labour in districts farther from metropolitan markets. A district skills

programme should publish retention after six months, median earnings and placement by gender and social group rather than only enrolment and certificates. Because work quality is multidimensional, an answer should avoid the misleading conclusion that a decline in measured unemployment proves the absence of labour distress.

Cycle 103 source-bounded check

PLFS denominator check (2023–24 annual report listed 10 October 2024). In a hypothetical population of 1,000 persons, with 600 in the labour force and 570 employed, LFPR is 60%, WPR 57%, and unemployment is 30/600 = 5%, not 3%. A falling unemployment rate can accompany reduced participation if people cease seeking work. Comparisons require matching age band, usual or current-weekly reference status, survey period and geographic coverage. Assess earnings and job quality separately.

4. Child labour: a rights, schooling and household-income issue

A child's work can range from age-appropriate light household tasks to dangerous or exploitative employment. In legal analysis distinguish a **child** (under 14, subject to the applicable RTE-linked definition) from an **adolescent** (14–18). Under the Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986 as amended in **2016**, employment of children is generally prohibited, with narrowly framed statutory exceptions, while adolescents are prohibited in specified hazardous occupations and processes. The legal treatment of permitted family assistance outside school hours has attracted criticism because it can conceal commercial production. Do not write that every form of helping at home is automatically an offence, or that adolescents can freely work in mines.

Child labour is a cause and consequence of deprivation. Debt, insecure adult employment and migration may prompt reliance on a child's earnings; the lost schooling then reduces future employability and perpetuates vulnerability. Gender matters: girls' domestic work may be invisible in workplace inspections and can combine with sibling care. Employer demand persists where subcontracting, home-based production and poorly monitored supply chains make child work inexpensive and difficult to detect. The **Right to Education Act 2009** establishes free and compulsory elementary education for children aged **6–14**, but enrolment must be supported by transport, safe school facilities, learning support and language inclusion.

Policy must integrate age verification, labour inspection, rescued-child rehabilitation, bridge schooling, social protection for caregivers and worker protections for adults. In Telangana, distinguish urban workshop/home-production risks, migrant construction settlements and seasonal rural migration; do not label a specific industrial cluster or community as employing children without evidence. **Outcomes** include sustained re-enrolment, learning recovery, absence of re-entry into hazardous work and improved household resilience. Treat the 2016 amendment as a legal rule, not proof that the practice disappeared.

Integrated analytical deepening — repair 4: Child labour: the family-enterprise exception requires careful interpretation

The Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986, as amended in 2016, generally prohibits employment of children below 14, subject to tightly framed statutory exceptions, and prohibits adolescents aged 14–18 from specified hazardous occupations and processes. The Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009, concerns compulsory elementary education for children aged 6–14. These laws are complementary but not identical. A school enrolment record cannot establish that a child is free from work, and a workplace inspection cannot establish that the child has been reintegrated into learning.

The family-enterprise exception is particularly sensitive in subcontracted, home-based production. A child may appear to be helping relatives, while a commercial contractor controls deadlines and prices. An investigator should establish who supplies raw material, who sets output targets, whether the child misses school, whether work occurs during prohibited hours, and whether health or safety is endangered. The objective is to identify the real economic relationship rather than accept the label 'family assistance' at face value. Children must not be treated as offenders. A rescue without schooling, family income stabilisation and follow-up can result in re-entry into work.

In Telangana, a hypothetical migrant household moving between brick-making or construction sites illustrates the need for portable school admissions, bridge learning, language support and tracking across districts. Administrative indicators should include attendance sustained for two academic terms, age-appropriate learning, rehabilitation access and timely prosecution of exploitative employers where evidence warrants it. **Counterpoint:** a blanket punitive approach that destroys adult livelihoods without income support may worsen household vulnerability. Effective enforcement therefore couples child protection with adult labour rights.

Cycle 103 source-bounded check

Child-labour statute boundary (2016 amendment). The general prohibition on employing children includes constrained statutory exceptions; adolescent hazardous work is separately prohibited. Family-enterprise activity is not automatically lawful. Inspect age, school hours, work conditions and the exact legal exception before making a claim. Sustained schooling and learning after rescue measure outcomes better than rescue totals alone.

5. Violence against women: continuum of harm and access to justice

Violence against women includes physical, sexual, psychological and economic coercion in domestic, workplace, public and digital settings. The **Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, 2005** recognises forms of abuse beyond physical assault and provides a civil-protection framework, whereas criminal offences are dealt with under relevant penal laws. The **Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013** requires workplace redressal mechanisms; institution-specific internal committees and local committees are not interchangeable. Crime statistics count recorded reports, not the actual prevalence of violence, and a rise in complaints can reflect changed reporting as well as incidence.

At least four mechanisms require analysis: **unequal bargaining power** in the family or workplace; **normalisation of controlling behaviour**; economic dependence and housing insecurity that make exit costly; and **institutional barriers** including stigma, unsafe reporting, weak evidence preservation and delayed proceedings. Online abuse adds non-consensual image sharing, stalking and reputational harm; any legal discussion must use the law applicable at the relevant date rather than recycling pre-2024 penal-section numbers as if unchanged.

A survivor-centred response joins emergency health care, privacy, police and judicial accountability, shelter, legal aid and livelihood support. Prevention also needs education about consent, transport design, safe workplaces and men's participation in norm change. Hyderabad's urban transit, service-work and digital-employment environments supply useful **settings**, but no safety claim should be made without data. Assess response times, compliance of workplace committees, survivor satisfaction, protection-order effectiveness and repeat victimisation; conviction rate alone is incomplete.

Examinable distinction: women’s empowerment is an ongoing distribution of voice, assets and freedom, not merely the presence of a women's welfare scheme.

Integrated analytical deepening — repair 5: Violence against women: distinguish reporting, prevalence and institutional response

Police-recorded crime statistics depend on both the underlying incidence and willingness or ability to report. More recorded complaints may reflect increased access to police, greater trust, changed legal definitions or increased harm; the direction cannot be inferred from the count alone. Surveys, service-use data, court outcomes and qualitative studies answer different questions. A careful answer never treats a lower reporting rate as proof of safety or a higher reporting rate as proof that a policy has failed.

The Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, 2005, recognises physical, sexual, verbal, emotional and economic abuse and provides civil protective remedies. The Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, establishes workplace duties and complaint mechanisms. Their institutional settings differ; neither substitutes for criminal-law processes where offences are alleged. The practical problem is often the path between complaint and relief: safe disclosure, confidentiality, immediate protection, access to healthcare, housing, legal aid and freedom from retaliation. For women in informal work, domestic work or small enterprises, workplace redressal structures may be difficult to access in practice.

An urban Telangana district can map gaps in last-mile transport, shelter availability and protection-officer workloads without disclosing survivor identities. Measure time to first protective action, compliance with orders and continuity of livelihood. **Limitation:** an apparently efficient complaint dashboard can expose survivors if identifiers are widely shared. Data minimisation and restricted access are essential, not optional administrative details.

6. Regionalism: representation, imbalance and constructive federalism

Regionalism is the political assertion of interests based on territory, language, historical experience, resources or identity. It may express a legitimate claim for fair allocation and self-government; it can also become exclusionary when it denies equal citizenship to newcomers. **Regional disparity** refers to unequal development, while **regional identity** expresses attachment to a place. The two overlap but are not identical. A mains answer should analyse fiscal transfers, public employment, irrigation, education, administrative access and cultural recognition before judging a movement.

The Telangana movement offers a concrete case of demands around jobs, water, budget allocation, cultural dignity and the interpretation of safeguards within undivided Andhra Pradesh. Major historical markers include the **Gentlemen's Agreement (1956)**, the **1969 Telangana agitation**, later organisational mobilisation and the **Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014**, under which Telangana came into being on **2 June 2014**. These are different moments with different legal and political status; do not present the 1956 agreement as an ordinary interstate treaty or infer that all grievances vanished at state formation.

Federalism can accommodate differences through constitutional statehood arrangements, Finance Commission transfers, local devolution, transparent recruitment, river-basin negotiations and independent impact audits. However, new state borders do not by themselves solve intra-state inequality between Hyderabad and more remote districts. **The analytical conclusion** is that democratic regionalism can widen representation, while a fair federation requires enforceable allocation rules, inclusive services and institutional channels for inter-regional negotiation.

Cycle 103 focused concept expansion — 6

Regionalism as a constitutional bargaining problem. A regional movement can express demands for fair resource allocation and political voice without rejecting national unity. Telangana illustrates why the chronology must be separated from the evaluation: the Telangana region joined Andhra State in the 1956 reorganisation, while Telangana became a separate state on **2 June 2014**, as recorded in the Telangana Government's state profile. The creation of a new state is a constitutional event; it does not by itself demonstrate that every district has equitable water, schooling, health or employment outcomes. A strong mains answer distinguishes historical grievances from contemporary within-state inequalities. It should compare institutional mechanisms: legislative representation, transparent budget allocation, local-government capacity and grievance redressal. A hypothetical district comparison might track per-capita public spending alongside travel time to secondary hospitals, irrigation reliability and secondary-school completion, rather than using one headline allocation. This prevents a false choice between national integration and regional dignity. **Evidence limit:** the official state profile supports the 1956 and 2014 dates, not a numerical claim about post-2014 inequality.

7. Communalism and secularism: conceptual distinctions and prevention

Communalism is political reasoning that treats religious communities as unified, inherently opposed interest blocs. It is not a synonym for individual religious devotion, minority cultural rights or ordinary doctrinal difference. Differentiate everyday prejudice, organised political mobilisation, discriminatory practice and collective violence. Rumour cascades, inflammatory speech, segregation, economic competition, selective historical narratives and impunity can amplify conflict, but no single causal factor explains all episodes.

Indian secularism is often understood as constitutional **equal citizenship and principled state engagement** rather than a complete prohibition on all state interaction with religion. Articles **14, 15 and 16** support equality and nondiscrimination; **Articles 25–28** govern religious freedom and related limits; **Articles 29–30** address cultural and educational protections. The State may regulate secular aspects of religious institutions and enact social-reform measures within constitutional limits. “Equal respect” cannot be used to excuse discrimination or remove scrutiny of state decisions.

Hyderabad's long-standing Telugu, Urdu/Dakhni and other linguistic and religious interactions illustrate composite urban traditions, yet cultural coexistence does not mean conflict is impossible. Good governance requires prompt, impartial investigation of violence, protection of threatened residents, accountable policing, peace committees with credible representation, critical media literacy and nondiscriminatory public services. **Mains nuance:** reconciliation does not replace justice, and constitutional secularism protects both the freedom to practise religion and the citizen's freedom from coercion.

Integrated analytical deepening — repair 11: Communalism, regionalism and corruption: constitutional safeguards with implementation capacity

Regional identity can be a legitimate claim for representation, cultural dignity and more equitable public investment; it becomes exclusionary when rights are denied to people based on language or origin. Telangana's statehood history illustrates the distinction between constitutional territorial reorganisation and hostility toward individual migrants. A strong answer explains grievance, institutional channel, democratic mobilisation and safeguards for minorities and residents. Similarly, secularism in India is not equivalent to an absence of religion from society. Constitutional commitments to equality, freedom of conscience and religious rights require public institutions to protect individuals without selective enforcement.

Communal conflict often grows when misinformation, elite incentives, residential segregation and weak enforcement reinforce each other. Administrators must distinguish protected expression from incitement or violence under applicable law and act proportionately. Preventive coordination, credible public communication and independent investigation matter more than generic appeals for harmony. Claims about a particular incident should not be inserted without a verifiable primary record.

Corruption includes petty extraction at service counters, collusion in procurement and systemic capture of regulation. Digitising an application can reduce face-to-face discretion but can also centralise gatekeeping or hide algorithmic exclusion. The Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988, as amended in 2018, must be understood alongside procurement controls, transparency, internal audit, conflict-of-interest rules and whistleblower safeguards. Measure the time and cost to obtain a service, complaint resolution and audit exceptions—not merely the number of online transactions.

8. Corruption: incentives, discretion, capture and institutional design

Corruption is misuse of entrusted authority for private advantage; it includes bribery, extortion, patronage, conflict of interest, embezzlement and state capture. **Petty bribery** differs from **grand corruption** and **regulatory capture**, where rules may themselves be shaped to favour powerful actors. The Prevention of Corruption Act **1988**, amended in **2018**, provides criminal-law architecture; the **Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act 2013**, transparency arrangements and audit institutions form other parts of accountability. Details about sanction for prosecution, offences and amended provisions need current statutory checking before being asserted in examination notes.

Social consequences exceed the value of an illicit payment. Corruption can distort infrastructure quality, steer public procurement away from value for money, discriminate against people lacking influence, degrade trust and convert entitlements into favour. Vulnerable citizens may suffer **regressive corruption costs** because fixed unofficial fees form a higher share of their resources. A rent-seeking explanation points to monopoly plus discretion minus accountability, but a formula is a heuristic, not an empirical law.

Prevention requires open contracting, clearly published eligibility rules, time-bound public-service standards, digitised traceable workflows with accessible offline alternatives, independent audits, whistleblower protection and effective grievance appeal. Digital processes can also create new risks: algorithmic exclusion, opaque vendor decisions and data manipulation. Telangana's service-delivery setting can be analysed through land records, licences, urban permissions and welfare distribution without presuming wrongdoing by any particular department. Measure independent complaint disposal, competitive procurement, audit closure and citizen time/cost—not only the number of digital transactions.

Cycle 103 focused concept expansion — 8

Corruption as a principal-agent and collective-action problem. A bribe can arise where an official controls a scarce approval, decisions are opaque, delays impose costs and appeal routes are weak. A principal-agent explanation asks whether supervisors can detect and sanction misconduct; a collective-action explanation asks why citizens and officials expect others to behave corruptly. Digitising an application may reduce face-to-face discretion but can also move rent-seeking into document verification or procurement design. An effective integrity framework therefore combines clear service standards, time-stamped audit trails, transparent tender criteria, protected reporting, conflict-of-interest declarations and independent complaint resolution. Consider a hypothetical building permit: measure median processing time, unexplained rejection rates, number of appeals resolved and changes in repeat inspections. A reduction in complaints alone is ambiguous because citizens may fear reporting. Avoid presenting a particular law as a universal solution: statutory offences, prevention, departmental discipline and citizen remedies operate at different levels. **Evidence boundary:** these are governance mechanisms, not verified case findings.

9. Caste conflicts: power, land, dignity and constitutional equality

Caste conflicts are not adequately explained as ancient prejudice surviving unchanged. Modern conflicts may concern land, wages, access to common resources, inter-caste marriages, local elections, education, reservation claims and assertions of equal status. Ambedkar's analysis of graded inequality illuminates hierarchy; M.N. Srinivas's concept of the **dominant caste** shows how numerical strength, land and local political power can operate independently of ritual rank. Rising education and assertion of rights can generate resistance from entrenched power, so visible conflict may accompany social change rather than only its absence.

The Constitution abolishes untouchability in **Article 17** and prohibits multiple forms of discrimination; the **Protection of Civil Rights Act 1955** and **SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act 1989**, as amended, provide legal protections. Yet a complaint count is influenced by reporting, policing and awareness. Social inclusion must address land and tenancy, common access, educational segregation, public representation, local dispute resolution and victim protection. Use Telangana's village land, labour and panchayat contexts as settings while identifying facts for each actual case before citing it.

Mains high-value sequence: changing local power → assertion of dignity or resource claims → possible backlash → rights enforcement and dialogue → measurable institutional equality. Avoid framing caste violence as a symmetrical disagreement when the evidence points to unequal coercive power.

Integrated analytical deepening — repair 6: Caste conflict, agricultural labour and land relations

Caste conflict cannot be reduced to personal prejudice. Control over land, credit, local political offices, tenancy, social networks and access to public goods can make caste hierarchies economically self-reinforcing. Agricultural labourers may experience a triple dependency on the same employer for wages, housing and emergency loans. A demand for statutory wages or access to common land can therefore be experienced as a challenge to local power, increasing the risk of retaliation. Women labourers may face additional vulnerabilities in wage setting and harassment. A mains answer should connect **social hierarchy → bargaining asymmetry → labour-market segmentation → unequal outcomes**.

The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, supplies a specific legal framework for defined atrocities and associated procedures. It does not replace the need for reliable police investigation, witness protection, land-record correction or fair public-service delivery. The Constitution's equality and anti-discrimination guarantees must be analysed alongside the actual capacity to enforce them. The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005, can improve a rural worker's fallback option, potentially increasing bargaining power, but delayed wages and insufficient work demand weaken that effect. A programme guaranteeing up to 100 days per eligible rural household is not the same as 100 days automatically received by each individual.

A Telangana case could examine a village where workers complain that wages differ by gender and social group. The administration should verify wage records, conduct confidential interviews, inspect worksite conditions, enforce applicable protections and provide a grievance channel outside the employer's influence. A simplistic response that relies solely on mediation may leave structural intimidation intact. Outcome indicators include actual wage parity, safe reporting and continuity of work—not the number of meetings convened.

10. Agricultural labour: insecurity despite high rural employment

Agricultural labourers sell labour to farm operators and may be landless, marginal cultivators who also work for wages, seasonal migrants or long-term attached workers. Employment is concentrated around sowing, weeding and harvesting, creating idle periods and bargaining weakness. **Agricultural workers and farmers are overlapping but not interchangeable populations**; policies that raise crop prices may not automatically increase labourers' incomes. Wages depend on crop mix, mechanisation, rural nonfarm alternatives, labour mobility and gendered task segregation. Tenancy uncertainty and informal credit can trap workers in dependent relationships.

Distinct problems include irregular wages, absence of written contracts, unsafe chemical exposure, heat stress, inadequate child care, debt dependence, weak social protection and poor housing near work. In Telangana, cotton or paddy labour demand is seasonal and local practices vary; do not generalise one district's pattern statewide. The historical MGNREGA **100-day household** framework, replaced from **1 July 2026** by the VB–G RAM G Act's **125-day household** guarantee, illustrates how a credible fallback can improve bargaining power; road access, rural processing, skill mobility and childcare create complementary alternatives. Both legal design and actual work availability must be assessed. Labour inspection alone cannot solve dispersed informal worksites; worker collectives, wage information and grievance services matter.

The answer should examine **both labour demand and bargaining capacity**. Indicators include real daily wages, days worked per year, occupational injury, women's wage gaps, credit cost and receipt of earned wages on time. A rise in agricultural output with stagnant labour earnings signals unequal sharing of productivity gains.

Cycle 103 focused concept expansion — 10

Household guarantee versus individual labour rights — historical and current law. The **2005 MGNREGA**, now repealed effective **1 July 2026**, guaranteed at least **100 days of unskilled wage employment per financial year per eligible rural household**, not per adult. Under the **VB–G RAM G Act 2025**, in force from that date, the statutory guarantee is **125 days per eligible rural household**. For a worked illustration, if two adults receive 70 and 55 person-days respectively, the household reaches 125 person-days in total, not 125 days each. A guarantee on paper does not demonstrate that work was actually offered on demand, wages were timely, or assets were durable. The 2026 transition requires evaluation of implementing rules and district delivery rather than an assumption of seamless performance. Agricultural labourers also face seasonal private-market wage fluctuations, tenancy exclusion, occupational hazards and unpaid care burdens. For a Telangana rural labour analysis, distinguish demand for work, days actually provided, delays, real wage levels and quality of durable water-conservation assets. A complete response asks whether public employment reduces distress migration or merely smooths consumption during a lean season. **Evidence limit:** the portal confirms the programme's stated entitlement, not actual district-level performance.

11. Urbanisation: demographic change versus the urban way of life

Urbanisation means a rising proportion of people or settlements classified as urban, while **urban growth** may describe an increase in the number of urban residents even without an increasing urban share. **Urbanism** refers to social organisation and lifestyles; **peri-urbanisation** describes transformation at city edges; **metropolitan primacy** denotes concentration in one dominant city. Data comparisons must account for changing administrative boundaries and settlement reclassification. Migration, natural increase and reclassification contribute differently across towns.

Cities can improve productivity through job matching, specialisation, infrastructure and knowledge spillovers. But they also create land-price pressure, unequal access to water, informal housing and climate exposure. Hyderabad's historic core, Secunderabad, older industrial clusters and western IT corridor form an uneven urban geography. A peripheral apartment complex may have high economic value while nearby low-income settlements lack safe walking access or reliable drainage. The Musi catchment and connected tanks show why flooding is a watershed-management challenge rather than simply a failure to widen a drain.

The policy response needs **metropolitan spatial coordination**, rental housing, secure tenure where feasible, integrated buses and Metro, safe footpaths, stormwater and wastewater management, and balanced growth in secondary towns. GHMC's municipal functions and HMDA's metropolitan planning role are different. Judge transit by **door-to-door accessibility**, not route length, and assess housing by affordability relative to income, not only units sanctioned.

Cycle 103 focused concept expansion — 11

Urban classification is not the same as urban living conditions. The Government of India's Indian Economic Service distinguishes statutory towns from census towns. Under the Census 2011 criteria, a census town required a population of at least 5,000, at least 75% of **male main workers** in non-agricultural pursuits and density of at least 400 persons per square kilometre. These are classification rules, not proof of reliable sanitation, transport or tenure security. For example, a settlement may satisfy the census-town criteria while lacking a statutory municipality with adequate revenue capacity. A sound urbanisation answer compares demographic growth, functional commuting links, jurisdictional changes and service access. In Hyderabad, distinguish the metropolitan labour market from the powers of specific municipal and planning authorities; do not equate the entire urban agglomeration with one administrative boundary. Evaluate affordable housing, travel time to jobs, drinking-water continuity and drainage exposure by neighbourhood. **Evidence limit:** the official definition verifies classification thresholds, not a 2026 Telangana town count.

12. Development and displacement: who gains and who loses?

Displacement occurs when infrastructure, mines, industries, conservation, urban renewal or disasters cause people to lose residence, land, workplaces or access to resources. **Physical displacement** means relocation of homes; **economic displacement** can occur without changing residence when livelihoods, common land, grazing or fishing access are lost. A compensation cheque for titled land does not automatically replace common-property dependence, rental networks or community institutions. Michael Cernea's impoverishment-risks model highlights **landlessness, joblessness, homelessness, marginalisation, food insecurity, morbidity, loss of common resources and social disarticulation**.

The **Right to Fair Compensation and Transparency in Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement Act, 2013** provides provisions for social-impact assessment, public processes and rehabilitation/resettlement in cases governed by it. Legal exceptions, state modifications and project categories must be checked separately; no one should claim every land transfer follows identical procedures. In Telangana, discuss irrigation reservoir or urban infrastructure projects as analytical settings but avoid assigning unverified displacement numbers to a named scheme.

A rights-sensitive evaluation asks: Who was counted in the affected population? Were tenant cultivators, sharecroppers, forest-resource users and informal workers visible? Did compensation reflect productive replacement costs? Were replacement housing, schools, public transport, jobs and cultural sites secured **before** displacement? Longitudinal monitoring should cover income restoration, schooling continuity, legal title, community ties and grievance disposal. Development is credible only when its beneficiaries and its social costs are both disclosed.

Integrated analytical deepening — repair 7: Development and displacement: compensation is not livelihood restoration

Infrastructure may provide broad public benefits while concentrating costs on particular families. Physical displacement means relocation of residence; economic displacement includes loss of fields, grazing access, fishing, forest produce, customers or transport routes even where a home remains standing. The Right to Fair Compensation and Transparency in Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement Act, 2013, includes provisions for social impact assessment, consultation and rehabilitation, subject to the Act's application and specified exceptions. A district official must examine the legally applicable acquisition route rather than assume identical procedures govern every project or land category.

The core analytical distinction is **replacement of an asset** versus **restoration of a livelihood system**. A cash payment for land may not replace shared water access, local credit, nearby markets or a woman's informal income. Landowners, tenants, sharecroppers and landless labourers can bear different losses; a survey that records only titleholders understates the affected population. In Scheduled Areas, additional constitutional and statutory safeguards may apply, requiring separate verification of land and community rights. Public hearings are not meaningful when documents are inaccessible or participation is coerced.

Consider a hypothetical Telangana reservoir expansion. Before acquisition, map household and community assets, crop cycles, common resources, occupational dependencies and potential host-site services. After relocation, monitor actual earnings, school attendance, potable water, health access and grievances over several years. A narrow project completion certificate proves construction, not social rehabilitation. **Counterargument:** delayed infrastructure also imposes costs on prospective beneficiaries. The defensible position is transparent alternatives analysis and fair burden-sharing, not an automatic rejection or approval of every project.

Cycle 103 source-bounded check

Displacement audit illustration. Distinguish loss of titled land from loss of tenancy, common resources, customer access and school continuity. Hypothetically compare households before relocation and at years one, three and five using real earnings, commute time, access to services and hazard exposure. A compensation payment is an output, not proof of livelihood restoration. This is an evaluation method, not evidence about a named Telangana project.

13. Environmental degradation: an unequal distribution of harm

Environmental degradation includes polluted air and water, soil erosion, groundwater depletion, habitat fragmentation, heat stress and loss of wetlands. Distinguish **emissions** (a flow of pollutants) from **ambient concentration** (actual exposure), and **resource scarcity** from **inequitable access**. Disadvantaged communities may face higher exposure because inexpensive housing lies near traffic, drains, industrial sites or floodplains. Exposure also varies with age, disability, occupation and indoor conditions.

India's regulatory instruments include the **Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974**, **Air Act 1981**, **Environment (Protection) Act 1986**, environmental-impact assessment procedures, and constitutional reasoning based on **Article 21** and **Article 48A**. Do not imply the Right to a Healthy Environment is expressed verbatim as a standalone fundamental right in the constitutional text; judicial interpretation is important. In Telangana, link the Musi river's sewage and industrial pollution concerns, depleted urban lakes, quarry dust and coal extraction to particular monitoring needs rather than sensationalising local contamination without data.

Environmental policy must combine source control, transparent measurements, public health surveillance and fair cost allocation. Actions may involve effluent treatment, sewer connections, catchment restoration, safe mobility and livelihood transition for affected workers. **Environmental justice** asks not only how to reduce total pollution but also how costs and benefits fall on different communities. Indicators: pollutant concentration at neighbourhood scale, illness burden, groundwater quality, enforcement closure and restoration of ecological functions.

Cycle 103 focused concept expansion — 13

Environmental harm as exposure multiplied by vulnerability. A polluted stream does not affect every household equally. Downstream informal settlements may have less access to alternative water sources, while households with secure housing can more readily avoid flood-prone sites. A practical environmental-justice analysis separates the source of a pollutant, the transport pathway, exposure duration, population vulnerability and the capacity of enforcement institutions. Consider a hypothetical industrial drain: one monitoring point upstream and another downstream could indicate deterioration, but attribution requires upstream baseline conditions, sampling dates, flow, season and other discharge sources. The UN 2030 Agenda's Goal 6.3 calls for improving water quality through pollution reduction and wastewater treatment; this is a policy target, not evidence that a particular waterbody has improved. Strong responses combine source-control inspections, wastewater-treatment reliability, independent water testing, transparent public reporting and accessible grievance redressal. Use a trend across seasons rather than a single sample to assess effectiveness. **Evidence limit:** no site-specific Telangana contamination claim is made here.

14. Sustainable development: not a slogan but a test of trade-offs

The **Brundtland Commission (1987)** defined sustainable development as meeting present needs without compromising future generations' ability to meet theirs. The **2030 Agenda and its 17 Sustainable Development Goals** connect poverty, decent work, gender equality, climate, institutions and ecological protection. Sustainability has **economic**, **social** and **environmental** dimensions, but treating them as three independent boxes misses their interactions. For example, a subsidised lift-irrigation project may raise farm income yet impose long-term electricity and aquifer costs; benefits and risks must be evaluated together.

Distinguish **weak sustainability**, which tolerates substitution of some natural capital with produced capital, from **strong sustainability**, which emphasises irreplaceable ecological thresholds and critical natural systems. Climate adaptation addresses impacts already occurring or expected; mitigation reduces causes such as greenhouse-gas emissions. A good Telangana illustration links heat action for outdoor workers, reliable urban water services, resilient transport and ecosystem protection. Distribution matters: a city may appear 'green' while shifting waste, quarrying and water burdens to nearby villages.

Use measurable outcomes such as water productivity, safe air exposure, renewable-energy output alongside total demand, worker heat-risk protections, inclusion in decision-making and lifecycle costs. **Mains line:** an environmentally efficient project that impoverishes displaced households is not socially sustainable; a welfare promise that destroys long-run water security is not environmentally sustainable.

Cycle 103 focused concept expansion — 14

Three dimensions and trade-off accounting. The United Nations' 2030 Agenda describes sustainable development as balancing economic, social and environmental dimensions through 17 integrated goals. A road project may shorten freight journeys while fragmenting habitat and displacing low-income households. A complete appraisal compares alternatives, who gains and who bears costs, mitigation feasibility and outcomes over the asset's life. A hypothetical option matrix might score transport time savings, emissions, relocation costs, ecological risk and access to services, while documenting the weights and uncertainty. These scores are decision aids, not objective facts. Distribution matters: aggregate net benefits can be positive even when a small vulnerable group suffers serious uncompensated losses. Therefore include social-impact assessment where applicable, transparent public consultation, independent monitoring and an enforceable remedy. Connect SDG 8 (decent work), 11 (inclusive cities), 12 (responsible consumption), 13 (climate) and 16 (institutions), without claiming that naming SDGs proves achievement. **Evidence limit:** the UN source establishes the integrated framework, not project-specific success.

15. Population growth, transition and demographic opportunity

The syllabus uses 'population explosion', but contemporary analysis must use the **demographic transition** rather than assume that all regions face accelerating fertility. The transition moves from high mortality and fertility toward lower mortality and fertility, with phases differing by state, community and time. **Total fertility rate (TFR)** estimates lifetime births per woman implied by age-specific current fertility rates; it is not the crude birth rate. **Population momentum** can sustain population growth after fertility declines because the reproductive-age population remains large. Another region may instead face ageing and a rising old-age dependency burden.

Assess births, deaths, migration and age structure together. The **demographic dividend** is a potential economic benefit from a favourable working-age share, not an automatic payout: it requires education, skills, health, women's workforce participation and productive jobs. Telangana and Hyderabad face a composite picture: mobility and youth employment alongside emerging elder-care demands. Policies should expand reproductive choice, maternal care, girls' schooling and affordable child care, rather than treating coercive population measures as effective or constitutionally unproblematic.

Common error: equating population size with unemployment, poverty or environmental damage without examining productivity, consumption patterns and institutions. A smaller but very resource-intensive population can impose heavy ecological costs; well-designed services can improve outcomes even in densely settled areas. The appropriate framework is rights-based demographic planning using dated Census, NFHS and registration data.

Integrated analytical deepening — repair 10: Population, environment and sustainability: avoid demographic alarmism

The phrase 'population explosion' in the syllabus should be treated analytically, not as an invitation to stigmatise large families. Population change depends on fertility, mortality, migration and age structure. Even after fertility falls, a youthful population can continue growing through demographic momentum. A lower total fertility rate does not automatically solve unemployment, and a higher elderly share creates different care and pension challenges. Rights-based reproductive healthcare, women's education, health access and informed choice are more defensible than coercive demographic targets.

Environmental degradation often reflects cumulative externalities: one enterprise's discharge, many households' waste, loss of wetlands and inadequate sewage treatment can combine to damage water quality. Poor communities frequently face greater exposure while contributing less to pollution. Sustainable development therefore has at least three tests: ecological viability, distribution of benefits and burdens, and institutional accountability over time. An environmental clearance or planting target is an administrative output; changes in measured air or water quality and ecosystem function are outcomes. Distinguish the *polluter-pays principle* from the mistaken assumption that a fee licenses unlimited damage.

For Telangana, urban lake restoration and dryland groundwater governance are useful paired cases. Lake beautification without catchment sewage control will have limited effects; groundwater subsidies without extraction management can worsen long-run depletion. Good policy combines monitoring, enforcement, public participation, alternative livelihoods where restrictions are imposed, and independent evaluation. A mains conclusion should emphasise **intergenerational fairness** rather than claiming every economic-environmental trade-off has an effortless win-win solution.

16. Agrarian distress: beyond one drought or crop failure

Agrarian distress is sustained instability in farming livelihoods, debt and productive assets, not a synonym for a bad harvest. Risks arise from rainfall variability, pests, price volatility, input costs, fragmented holdings, tenancy, weak storage, market concentration, credit terms and uncertain compensation. **Production risk** concerns yield; **market risk** concerns price or sale conditions; **institutional risk** concerns contracts, eligibility, data quality and delayed payments. Farmers growing different crops face different risks and should not be portrayed as identical.

The **Cobweb model** helps explain how price expectations can produce cycles in agricultural supply, though real markets are more complex. **Terms of trade** between farm output and inputs matter because higher gross receipts may coexist with falling net margins. Cost concepts matter: gross revenue, paid-out costs, imputed family labour, rent and capital costs yield different profitability measures. Debt itself is not always evidence of distress; distress arises when repayment obligations exceed credible earning capacity or require harmful coping such as asset sales and school withdrawal.

Telangana cases can compare cotton price/pest exposure and paddy's water-energy demands. Tank and groundwater management affects income stability; crop procurement and market integration affect price realisation. Policy requires risk-appropriate insurance, transparent crop-loss assessment, non-exploitative credit, farmer producer organisations, timely settlement, extension services and diversification supported by real buyers. Social protection must reach **tenant cultivators and agricultural labourers**, not only titled landowners. Use suicides data with care: recorded incidence does not establish one universal cause and deserves humane, non-sensational interpretation.

Integrated analytical deepening — repair 8: Agrarian distress: separate yield risk, price risk, credit risk and tenancy risk

A farmer's gross crop revenue is approximately *quantity sold* × *realised price*. Net farm income also depends on seed, fertiliser, hired labour, irrigation, machinery rental, interest, transport, storage and household consumption needs. A good harvest can coincide with low net returns when market prices collapse; a high price can fail to help when drought destroys output. Yield insurance and procurement address different risks. A debt waiver can provide short-term relief but may bypass tenant cultivators borrowing informally, while recurring input costs and weak marketing remain unresolved. Agricultural labourers may lose wages during crop failure even when they do not own farmland or qualify for owner-focused assistance.

Telangana's dryland cropping systems and groundwater dependence make water risk highly location-specific. A blanket prescription to 'increase irrigation' can raise extraction and energy costs if aquifer recharge and cropping patterns are ignored. A better district approach maps crop-water suitability, market concentration, storage access, extension quality, tenancy documentation and non-farm employment. The analytical unit should include the **farm household and hired workers**, not only land title. Rural mental-health and financial counselling services are relevant as part of a broader welfare response; never reduce farmer distress to a single psychological explanation or publish unsupported suicide totals.

Evaluate policy by real net returns, debt-servicing burden, timely payments, groundwater trends and risk distribution across owners, tenants and labourers. Avoid attributing any one year's agricultural outcome entirely to a single scheme without considering rainfall, prices and other concurrent factors.

17. Migration: circulatory livelihoods and unequal urban citizenship

Migration is movement involving a change of usual residence or work location, and can be **intra-district, inter-district, interstate, international, seasonal, circular, temporary or permanent**. Seasonal workers may maintain rural household membership while working for part of the year in a city; a one-time census can miss the full circulation of labour. Push–pull explanations identify drought, wages, education and jobs, but migration networks, contractors, discrimination, policy and family strategies are equally important. Distinguish **distress migration** from an informed move that genuinely expands capabilities; migrants can experience both opportunity and insecurity.

In Telangana, Hyderabad attracts construction, service, education and knowledge-sector migration, while some households in dryland or tribal areas engage in seasonal work. The same household may depend on village farming, city wages and remittances. Informal tenants and circular migrants face barriers to school admission, healthcare continuity, voter registration, portable benefits and safe accommodation. Labour contractors can help match jobs while also increasing dependence when conditions are opaque.

Policy must build portable food and health entitlements, accessible documentation, language-sensitive schools, registration of workers without discrimination, safe hostel/rental accommodation and effective wage complaints. The **One Nation One Ration Card** portability architecture is relevant for eligible beneficiaries, but entitlement portability does not itself supply adequate housing or fair wages. Evaluate migrants by wage retention, access to care, children’s school continuity, workplace injuries, remittance security and ability to make informed choices. **Nuance:** the aim is not to stop all migration; it is to remove coercive conditions and protect mobility as a route to opportunity.

Integrated analytical deepening — repair 9: Migration and urbanisation: portability, informal settlements and city governance

Migration may be seasonal, circular, permanent, voluntary or distress-driven; many households combine village and city livelihoods. It is not inherently a failure. Remittances can diversify risk and finance education, while mobility can expose workers to exploitative contractors, insecure housing and gaps in school continuity. Administrative systems built around a permanent address are poorly suited to people who move frequently. The right response is portable access to essential services, credible wage enforcement and safe accommodation, not an assumption that every migrant should be prevented from moving.

Urbanisation has several measures: the share of population living in urban areas, absolute urban population growth, expansion of built-up land and the concentration of economic activity. These are not interchangeable. Hyderabad's metropolitan growth brings productivity and services, but congestion, high rents, air pollution and flood exposure can transfer costs to low-income settlements. A drain encroachment policy must balance environmental and public-safety needs with due process, livelihood consequences and resettlement options. Moving a household farther from jobs can raise transport expenses enough to undermine an otherwise improved dwelling.

A hypothetical worker family living near a Musi tributary faces flood risk but also proximity to jobs. A fair programme should disclose hazard maps, offer accessible hearings, identify realistic relocation options and track commuting time, school continuity and income after movement. The key test is whether a plan reduces **total risk and deprivation**, rather than simply removing visible informal housing from a map.

18. Cross-topic synthesis: how social problems reinforce one another

Social issues form a causal network rather than a catalogue. A failed monsoon can reduce farm earnings; debt can prompt circular migration; insecure urban accommodation can interrupt school; child work can reduce future skills; low wages and poor health can prolong poverty. Caste exclusion and gendered care duties make shocks more severe for some households. Conversely, a public-service improvement can influence several outcomes: reliable childcare may increase women's paid employment, improve child nutrition and reduce unsafe care arrangements. A watershed project that raises water reliability may reduce seasonal job loss but still exclude tenant farmers if land titles are the sole eligibility criterion.

Diagnostic chain for mains: Identify the initiating shock → exposure and structural inequality → household coping → institutional response → unintended consequence → measurable recovery. For Telangana, a useful two-location comparison is a drought-exposed rural settlement and a peripheral Hyderabad migrant neighbourhood. Avoid presenting either as a single uniform type; different families face different rights, assets and mobility options. Include the constitutional commitment to dignity and equality, and one practicable interdepartmental recommendation.

Integrated analytical deepening — repair 12: Three integrated administrative cases for answer enrichment

Case A — seasonal migration and child work. A family leaves a dryland village for construction work; a teenager stops attending school and assists at a subcontracted site. The response should document the actual work relationship, prevent hazardous exploitation, enrol the child without avoidable documentation barriers, stabilise adult wages and coordinate origin/destination school records. **Trade-off:** prosecution alone may remove income; welfare without labour enforcement may leave exploitation untouched. **Indicator:** school attendance and learning after six months, not rescue numbers alone.

Case B — reservoir, tenant farmer and agricultural labour. A proposed irrigation project acquires titled fields but overlooks sharecroppers, seasonal workers and common grazing access. The district team should map livelihood dependence and the applicable land-acquisition, rehabilitation and Scheduled Area safeguards, consult affected groups and verify post-relocation earnings. **Trade-off:** downstream irrigation benefits are real, but concentrated losses require mitigation. **Indicator:** livelihood restoration by affected category rather than compensation disbursal alone.

Case C — flood-risk resettlement in metropolitan Hyderabad. A settlement near a drainage channel faces recurrent flooding and proposed clearance. Technical hazard evidence must be made accessible, housing options must be evaluated against jobs and schools, and grievances heard before coercive action where law requires it. **Trade-off:** in-situ protection may be costly, but remote relocation can destroy incomes. **Indicator:** lower flood exposure without increased commuting, dropout or debt.

19. Examination-ready distinctions and comparative anchors

Confused pair	Correct distinction	Why it matters
Monetary poverty / MPI	Command over income or consumption / multiple weighted deprivations	Trend conclusions depend on measure and survey year
Unemployment / underemployment	Not employed under survey definition / inadequate hours or productivity	Job quantity and job quality differ
PLFS UR / LFPR	Unemployed divided by labour force / labour force divided by population	Different denominators; never substitute
Child work / prohibited child labour	Appropriate activity may exist / law restricts child employment and hazardous adolescent work	Legal exceptions are limited and contested
Reported crime / prevalence	Registered cases / underlying actual incidence	Greater reporting may change registered counts
Regional identity / exclusionary regionalism	Constitutional assertion / denial of others' equal rights	Regionalism is not uniformly anti-national
Secularism / irreligion	State constitutional relation to religion / absence of belief	Religious freedom is protected
Farmer / agricultural labourer	Operator who undertakes production risk / person selling farm labour	Policies must target correct beneficiary
Urban growth / urbanisation	More urban residents / rising urban share and/or reclassification	Data categories and boundaries affect trends
Relocation / rehabilitation	Change of residence / restoration of livelihoods and social networks	Compensation alone is incomplete
Adaptation / mitigation	Reduce climate damage / reduce causes of climate change	Interventions and metrics differ
TFR / population momentum	Period fertility measure / growth from age structure	Declining fertility need not stop immediate growth
Circular / permanent migration	Repeated moves retaining origin link / durable relocation	Welfare portability priorities differ

Integrated analytical deepening — repair 13: Mains writing architecture: compare mechanisms, laws and indicators

For a 10-mark question, begin with a definition and one sentence establishing the tension. Use **Background / Root causes / Institutional framework / Telangana illustration / Limits / Way forward / Conclusion** as compact subheadings. Under each, add causal explanation rather than naming schemes. A law should be connected to the right it creates, the institution that implements it and the practical barrier to access. A statistic must state the reference year and denominator. A balanced answer distinguishes an intervention's intended benefit from a credible implementation failure. Avoid six identical 'awareness, training, monitoring' recommendations: tailor the instrument to the problem—wage payment for labour distress, land and livelihood restoration for displacement, survivor safety for violence, portable schooling for migrant children, groundwater management for dryland distress.

20. Recommended reading pathways, without page-number citations in the student chapter

Read NCERT Class XII *Indian Society* and *Social Change and Development in India* for concepts; Amartya Sen's *Development as Freedom* for capabilities; Jean Drèze and Amartya Sen's *An Uncertain Glory* for public-service and development reasoning; selected Indian sociology textbooks for caste, rural change and urbanisation; MoSPI PLFS methodology for labour denominators; NITI Aayog's MPI report for poverty measurement; Telangana Socio-Economic Outlook 2026 for dated state context; and the text of the child-labour, domestic-violence, labour-guarantee and land-acquisition laws for exact legal provisions. Treat textbooks as conceptual foundations, not as substitutes for up-to-date official data or operative statutes.

Integrated analytical deepening — repair 14: Evidence register and limits (editorial; source page numbers omitted)

Primary source / date	Verified proposition	Evidence limitation
NITI Aayog, *Multidimensional Poverty in India since 2005–06*, January 2024	2022–23 MPI headcount of 11.28% is extrapolated from earlier survey trend	Not a directly observed 2022–23 household census or 2026 poverty rate
MoSPI, *Annual PLFS 2025*, published May 2026	State tables distinguish usual-status employment measures; Telangana all-ages usual-status UR 5.0% (rural + urban, persons)	Different age groups, CWS and later monthly bulletins not interchangeable
India Code, RFCTLARR Act 2013, effective January 2014	Statutory SIA, acquisition, compensation and rehabilitation architecture	Application, exceptions, amendments and local rules require case-specific review
Ministry of Labour and Employment, Child and Adolescent Labour framework, 1986/2016	Child employment generally prohibited with constrained exceptions; adolescent hazardous work restricted	Need current official consolidated text and schedules before advising on a real case
MGNREGA 2005 (historical); VB–G RAM G Act 2025, effective 1 July 2026	The household statutory guarantee changed from 100 to 125 days when the 2005 law was repealed	MoRD PIB 11 May 2026 and India Code establish law/commencement; district delivery, fiscal effects and implementation remain unaudited
PWDVA 2005; POSH Act 2013	Distinct domestic-protection and workplace-redressal regimes	Local institutional performance not independently measured
SC/ST Prevention of Atrocities Act 1989	Specific statutory protection against defined atrocities	No inference about actual incidence from registered-case totals alone
Telangana district examples	Mechanisms of dryland risk, migration, metropolitan housing and land conflict	Illustrations are analytical, not audited local incidents or casualty statistics

Sources for verification (editorial links, not claims of independent approval):

- https://www.niti.gov.in/sites/default/files/2024-01/MPI-22_NITI-Aayog20254.pdf
- https://mospi.gov.in/uploads/publications_reports/publications_reports1780040415321_0624fb13-fb47-40bc-b470-7c7e9635c3ef_PLFS_2025_F_REV_29052026.pdf
- https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/13035/1/right_to_fair_compensation_act_2013.pdf
- https://labour.gov.in/acts/child-labour-16062014

Academic gate: This repair adds causal depth and source discipline. It does not independently validate every legacy statement, confer academic approval, authenticate official PYQs, or replace the existing PDF.

Part D — Visual learning

Visual learning and analytical diagrams

Social-issue feedback loop

Erratic income / exclusion / ecological shock
|
v
household debt
|
+------+-------+
| |
v v
child work circular migration
| |
v v
school disruption insecure urban housing
| |
+------+-------+
v
lower capabilities
|
v
persistent poverty

Policy logic hierarchy

Diagnosis → Causal mechanism → Legal entitlement → Service delivery
→ Accessible remedy → Outcome indicator → Independent audit

Population transition versus labour outcome

Fertility declines → Working-age share may rise
→ Jobs and women's work needed
→ Potential demographic dividend
→ Otherwise prolonged precarity

Displacement accountability chain

Project alternatives → Impact identification → SIA/hearing where required
→ Titleholders + tenants + common-resource users recognised
→ Replacement livelihoods, services, housing → multi-year monitoring

Telangana case-link grid

Setting	Mechanism	Appropriate metric
Dryland farming area	Weather + price shocks, credit	Real net farm income and debt-service burden
Rural labour market	Seasonal wage demand	Workdays, real wages, tail-end entitlements
Migrant urban settlement	Insecure tenure and service discontinuity	School continuity, rent/income, water access
Hyderabad western employment corridor	Matching, mobility, care work	Commute time, worker retention, women's participation
Musi catchment	Impervious land + drainage + pollution	Exposure, flood incidence and water quality
Reservoir-affected village	Economic displacement	Restored livelihood at year 1, 3 and 5

Part E — Thirty original four-option practice MCQs (not official PYQs)

Original practice questions — explained MCQs (not official PYQs)

1. Which is a correct interpretation of India's multidimensional poverty index?

A. It combines deprivations in health, education and living standards.
B. It measures only whether income is below a monetary poverty line.
C. It is identical to the unemployment rate.
D. It measures only consumption of food grains.

Answer: A. MPI combines weighted deprivations; it should not be substituted for monetary-poverty estimates. The NITI Aayog 2022–23 figure is an estimate, not a direct 2026 enumeration.

2. Which ratio uses the labour force, not the entire population, as denominator?

A. Worker Population Ratio (WPR)
B. Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR)
C. Unemployment Rate (UR)
D. Literacy rate

Answer: C. UR = unemployed persons / labour force. LFPR = labour force / population; WPR = workers / population. State the age band, activity status and reference period. **Distractors:** A and B use population denominators; D measures literacy rather than labour-market status.

3. The distinction between usual-status and current-weekly-status PLFS measures matters because they:

A. use the same activity reference period.
B. apply to different countries only.
C. classify activity using different reference periods.
D. measure only job satisfaction.

Answer: C. A current-weekly measure cannot be casually compared against a longer usual-status measure; this can change the employment classification.

4. Under the Child and Adolescent Labour law amended in 2016, which assertion is most accurate?

A. Child employment is generally prohibited, with legally specified limited exceptions, and adolescent hazardous work is prohibited.
B. Every adolescent aged 14–18 may work in hazardous mines.
C. All school attendance guarantees eliminate child labour.
D. The law defines adolescents as persons aged 18–21.

Answer: A. The statute includes a general child-employment prohibition with limited exceptions; adolescent hazardous occupations are specifically restricted. Age, work category and statutory exceptions must be checked.

5. The 2005 law providing civil protection from domestic abuse is distinct from:

A. the 2013 POSH statute on workplace harassment.
B. Articles 14–16.

C. the legal aid system.
D. housing support.

Answer: A. PWDVA provides domestic-protection remedies; POSH creates workplace prevention and redressal obligations. They address different institutional settings.

6. Which date is correctly associated with the establishment of Telangana state?

A. 1 November 1956
B. 2 June 2014
C. 15 August 1947
D. 1 May 1960

Answer: B. Telangana's state formation took effect on 2 June 2014 under the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014. **Distractors:** A concerns the 1956 reorganisation, not Telangana state formation; C is India's independence date; D is associated with Maharashtra and Gujarat state formation, not Telangana.

7. Which is NOT necessarily communalism?

A. Political mobilisation claiming communities have irreconcilable interests.
B. Spreading hatred between religious groups.
C. Peaceful observance of one's religious practices within constitutional limits.
D. Exclusionary stereotyping of another religious group.

Answer: C. Religious observance is not itself communalism; communalism is antagonistic political construction of religious community interests.

8. Which is the most helpful way to evaluate an anti-corruption e-governance initiative?

A. Count websites created.
B. Count computer terminals bought.
C. Track citizen service time, appeal access, audit findings and unjustified discretion.
D. Assume corruption ended after digitisation.

Answer: C. Digital interfaces may reduce contact points but can create fresh opacity or exclusion. Outcome indicators and appeals are essential.

9. M.N. Srinivas's idea of a dominant caste highlights:

A. the interaction of numbers, land and political influence.
B. ritual rank as the only dimension of caste power.
C. the absence of local conflict.
D. that caste determines occupation without change.

Answer: A. Dominance can arise through land, numbers, education and political power, not simply ritual prestige.

10. As of October 2026, which comparison of India's rural wage-employment guarantees is accurate?

A. Both the 2005 and 2025 laws guarantee 100 days for every adult individual.
B. MGNREGA 2005 provided at least 100 days per eligible rural household; the VB–G RAM G Act 2025 replaced it from 1 July 2026 and guarantees 125 days per eligible rural household.
C. The 2025 law removed every statutory rural household employment guarantee.
D. The 2025 law provides 125 days for each adult individual rather than for a household.

Answer: B. The entitlement unit is the **eligible rural household** under both statutes; the number of guaranteed days changed from **100** to **125**. The Government of India announced the repeal/commencement

date on **11 May 2026**, effective **1 July 2026**. **Distractors:** A and D incorrectly change the unit to an individual; C wrongly denies the new statutory guarantee. A legal entitlement is not proof of actual person-days or timely wages. Sources: MoRD/PIB 11 May 2026 and India Code, Act 36 of 2025.

11. Economic displacement can occur when a household:

A. loses access to grazing, fishing or wage opportunities without changing its residence.
B. moves home and retains every productive asset.
C. receives a school certificate.
D. experiences a temporary rain shower.

Answer: A. Compensation for land titles may fail to restore common-resource dependence and income networks.

12. A decline in TFR need not immediately stop population growth due to:

A. demographic momentum from age structure.
B. a mathematical necessity that deaths become zero.
C. the disappearance of migration.
D. changes in currency circulation.

Answer: A. A large population entering reproductive ages can sustain births while fertility per woman falls.

13. Which is the most defensible view of migration?

A. All migration must be prevented.
B. Every migrant automatically escapes poverty.
C. Migration can widen opportunity or reproduce vulnerability depending on rights, earnings, housing and service portability.
D. Circular migrants do not require access to schools.

Answer: C. Distinguish chosen opportunity-seeking moves from distress and contractor dependence.

14. The strongest indicator of sustainable urban transport is:

A. kilometres of Metro track alone.
B. total private vehicle sales.
C. affordable, safe door-to-door access incorporating walkability and feeder services.
D. number of flyovers announced.

Answer: C. Transport equity depends on actual accessibility, not exclusively high-profile construction totals.

15. Why is rehabilitation broader than compensation?

A. Rehabilitation includes livelihood recovery, services, networks and common resources.
B. Rehabilitation counts only property prices.
C. Rehabilitation need not identify affected households.
D. Rehabilitation necessarily ends when a cheque is issued.

Answer: A. Cernea's framework highlights multiple impoverishment risks beyond titleholder land value.

Questions 16–30 — original analytical repair

These are original practice questions, not authenticated commission PYQs.

16. A district publishes a rising number of child-labour rescues. What further indicator best establishes sustained success?

A. Number of press releases
B. Number of temporary shelters
C. Number of inspections only
D. School attendance and learning after reintegration

Answer: D. Rescue is an immediate administrative output; sustained educational reintegration better reflects the intended outcome.

17. Why is the NITI Aayog 11.28% figure for 2022–23 not a direct poverty census?

A. It is a nominal GDP growth rate
B. It is the urban unemployment rate
C. It counts only Hyderabad residents
D. It is a projected MPI headcount based on prior trends

Answer: D. The January 2024 discussion paper explicitly uses extrapolation; the measure is multidimensional, not a directly enumerated monetary-poverty rate.

18. According to the all-India Time Use Survey 2024, which interpretation of unpaid domestic-service participation is accurate?

A. 81.5% of women spent 81.5% of every day on unpaid domestic services.
B. Among persons aged six years and above, 81.5% of females and 27.1% of males participated in unpaid domestic services for household members during the survey day.
C. The figures measure the unemployment rate of the female and male labour forces.
D. The figures apply exclusively to working-age residents of urban Telangana.

Answer: B. MoSPI's 2024 Time Use Survey factsheet reports these **all-India, sex-specific participation rates for persons aged 6+**. Participation means performing an activity in the 24-hour reference period, not spending that percentage of the day on it. **Distractors:** A confuses participation with duration; C substitutes a labour-market rate; D invents a Telangana-only, urban, working-age population. Source: MoSPI, *Time Use Survey 2024 Factsheet*, released 25 February 2025.

19. A farm household reports a good harvest but negative net returns. Which explanation is most plausible?

A. Harvest volume always determines profit
B. Tenancy has no effect on income
C. Crop insurance guarantees profit
D. Input costs and realised prices can offset yield

Answer: D. Farm profitability depends on realised price and production/financing costs, not only quantity harvested.

20. Why might land compensation fail to restore displaced livelihoods?

A. All affected households are titleholders
B. Relocation cannot affect schooling
C. Cash transfers always create employment
D. Shared resources, tenancy and customer access may be lost

Answer: D. Economic displacement includes common-property and non-titleholder losses that cash for titled land may miss.

21. Which pairing of the Indian Constitution's rights against exploitation is correct?

A. Article 23 prohibits only child factory employment; Article 24 addresses trafficking and begar.
B. Article 23 prohibits trafficking in human beings, begar and similar forced labour; Article 24 prohibits

employment of children below 14 in factories, mines or other hazardous employment.
C. Article 23 requires every adolescent to accept compulsory private-sector employment.
D. Article 24 prohibits every form of adult employment in dangerous industries.

Answer: B. The Constitution separates the general ban on trafficking/forced labour (Article 23) from the specific under-14 hazardous-employment protection (Article 24). Article 23(2) permits nondiscriminatory compulsory service for public purposes; that qualification is not a licence for forced private labour. **Distractors:** A reverses the provisions; C invents a duty; D substitutes adults for children and exaggerates the scope. The separate Child and Adolescent Labour statute must not be confused with the constitutional text. Source: Legislative Department, *Constitution of India*, Part III, Articles 23–24.

22. An increase in registered violence complaints necessarily proves what?

A. Incidence increased
B. Trust and reporting improved
C. Neither without additional evidence
D. All interventions failed

Answer: C. Registered counts reflect reporting and recording as well as underlying incidence, requiring triangulation.

23. A programme trains 20,000 youths but reports no retention or wages. Its principal evaluation gap is:

A. Too many outcome measures
B. No publicity budget
C. Insufficient certificates
D. Lack of evidence about durable employment quality

Answer: D. Training completion is an output; job retention, earnings and work conditions test whether livelihoods improved.

24. Which scenario illustrates institutional exclusion rather than only resource scarcity?

A. A village has no nearby health centre
B. A storm destroys a crop
C. A drought reduces groundwater
D. A qualified worker is denied an available benefit because of mismatched identity records

Answer: D. A benefit exists but procedural barriers prevent access, demonstrating institutional exclusion.

25. What is the strongest way to assess flood-risk resettlement?

A. Count demolished dwellings
B. Count new road signs
C. Measure only construction speed
D. Compare risk, travel cost, income and schooling after relocation

Answer: D. Relocation should reduce hazard exposure without creating livelihood or education losses.

26. Under the Census of India 2011 definition, which combination identifies a census town rather than a statutory town?

A. At least 5,000 population, at least 400 persons per sq. km, and at least 75% of male main workers in non-agricultural pursuits.
B. At least 1,000 population, at least 100 persons per sq. km, and no occupational test.
C. Every settlement notified as a municipality, regardless of demographic characteristics.
D. At least 75% of all residents working outside agriculture, with no population or density threshold.

Answer: A. The 2011 Census criteria for a **census town** combine minimum population, density and the **male main-worker** non-agricultural share. **Distractors:** B gives false thresholds; C describes the separate *statutory town* route; D changes the denominator and drops two mandatory criteria. A census-town classification is not proof that municipal services or statutory municipal status have been provided. Source: Office of the Registrar General & Census Commissioner, *Census of India 2011—Rural–Urban Distribution of Population*, definition slide.

27. How can public employment programmes affect rural bargaining power?

A. By replacing all private jobs
B. By providing an outside wage option when work and payments are reliable
C. By automatically granting land ownership
D. By eliminating monsoon risk

Answer: B. A credible alternative can strengthen wage bargaining, though delays and insufficient availability weaken the effect.

28. Which statement correctly distinguishes regionalism from exclusion?

A. All regional demands violate the Constitution
B. Constitutional claims for representation differ from discrimination against residents by origin
C. Statehood always removes inequality
D. Regional language protection requires violence

Answer: B. Democratic territorial and cultural claims can coexist with equal individual rights; exclusion violates that balance.

29. Why can digital service delivery still reproduce corruption or exclusion?

A. Software eliminates all discretion
B. Opaque eligibility rules and inaccessible grievance systems can centralise gatekeeping
C. Online transactions require no audits
D. Digital identities cannot be incorrect

Answer: B. Technology can reduce some face-to-face discretion while creating new opaque bottlenecks if rules and redressal are weak.

30. A lake restoration project funds beautification but not upstream sewage interception. Its core weakness is:

A. Too much ecological monitoring
B. Treating a visible symptom without controlling pollutant inflow
C. Too many community meetings
D. Overestimating urban population

Answer: B. Without reducing catchment pollution, cosmetic works may fail to improve water quality or ecosystem health.

Part F — Eight original mains answers (once)

Professional Mains Answer Bank — Social Issues

Eight original practice prompts; none is presented as an official previous-year TGPSC question. The formal Paper-III pattern suggests answers of approximately 200 words for a 10-mark question. Each answer below prioritises a focused thesis, differentiated evidence, a Telangana illustration where useful, a limitation and an actionable conclusion.

Question 1. Poverty reduction cannot be assessed through income alone. Critically discuss.

Thesis and definition. Monetary poverty indicates shortfall against an income or consumption threshold, but deprivation also operates through health, schooling, sanitation, secure work and decision-making power. A household may cross a monetary line while remaining vulnerable to one illness or crop loss.

Distinct analytical points. First, the multidimensional-poverty framework captures weighted deprivations across health, education and living standards; it is conceptually different from measuring consumption poverty. Second, *transient poverty* may result from an accident, poor monsoon or job loss, whereas chronic poverty involves persistent constraints on assets and capabilities. Third, social exclusion prevents equal conversion of resources into opportunities: insecure tenants or socially disadvantaged communities may receive fewer benefits from similar income. Fourth, unpaid care, transport cost and debt mean household income conceals unequal individual access.

Evidence and Telangana application. NITI Aayog estimated India's multidimensional-poverty headcount at 11.28% for 2022–23, based on its specified estimation method; this must not be described as a 2026 monetary-poverty survey. Telangana's dryland farm families and Hyderabad's low-income renters face different vulnerability mechanisms.

Evaluation and conclusion. Policy should combine employment security, reliable primary services, health-risk protection and secure housing. Progress should be assessed through both monetary outcomes and multidimensional indicators, with clear reference periods and denominators. Poverty alleviation is durable when **capabilities and resilience**, not merely transfers, improve.

Question 2. Why can a falling unemployment rate coexist with persistent labour-market distress?

Introduction. A lower unemployment rate signals a specific improvement only when its *survey definition, population and reference period* are clear. It does not automatically establish adequate income or job quality.

Analytical body. Open unemployment is different from time-related underemployment, informal work or low-productivity family labour. PLFS usual-status estimates and current-weekly-status estimates use different time frames; the unemployment rate is calculated using the labour force as denominator, while LFPR and WPR use the population. A person taking poorly paid occasional work may be classified as employed even while seeking more hours. Women's entry into low-paid own-account work can raise participation without guaranteeing financial autonomy. Educated youth may remain unemployed when qualification, employer demand, location and hiring networks do not match. Hyderabad's IT and pharma employers need specialised capabilities, while rural graduates face mobility and training costs; informal service jobs can be accessible but insecure.

Institutional response. Labour-intensive manufacturing and urban services create demand; apprenticeships and local placement improve matching; childcare and safe mobility expand women's work choices; portable social insurance helps mobile workers. Rural employment guarantees are useful buffers but should not be mistaken for high-productivity permanent jobs.

Conclusion. Assess employment with **hours, real earnings, stability, safety, productivity and women's bargaining power** in addition to a properly dated UR. The test is not whether everyone recorded some work, but whether work secures dignified, sustainable livelihoods.

Question 3. Child labour reflects both household vulnerability and demand for cheap informal work. Analyse.

Introduction. Child labour is not caused by household poverty alone; insecure adult earnings interact with demand for inexpensive, difficult-to-monitor labour in subcontracted production and informal services.

Causes. When illness or debt reduces adult income, children may be withdrawn from school to earn money or provide unpaid household care. Lost learning and early occupational exposure then weaken adult earning capacity, reproducing deprivation. Informal workshops and home-based units may conceal commercial labour inside family settings, while migrant households face gaps in school continuity and documentation. Girls' domestic tasks are particularly undercounted. The Child and Adolescent Labour Act, amended in **2016**, generally prohibits employment of children under 14, permits legally constrained exceptions, and prohibits adolescents aged 14–18 from specified hazardous work. Its family-work exception is debated; the law is not a blanket permission for child employment.

Telangana application. For an urban migrant household, safe access to nearby schools, language support and stable adult wages may be as important as inspections. Rural seasonal migration demands admission flexibility and learning-recovery systems.

Way forward. Combine labour inspection with adult wage security, RTE-based schooling for ages 6–14, cash/food support for vulnerable households and rehabilitation of rescued children. Monitor **sustained attendance and learning**, not merely rescue counts.

Conclusion. Child labour prevention is a joined-up employment, education and child-protection obligation, not a one-department policing exercise.

Question 4. Examine the structural causes of violence against women and the limits of law-only approaches.

Introduction. Violence against women is sustained by unequal power and social norms as well as failures of public institutions. It spans physical, sexual, psychological and economic abuse, including digital harassment.

Explanation. Economic dependence can make separation from an abusive environment difficult. Shame and threats can reduce reporting; poor access to shelters and legal aid can prolong danger. Workplace hierarchies and precarious contracts obstruct complaints, especially for domestic, service and informal workers. The Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, **2005**, supplies a protection framework including non-physical harms. The POSH Act, **2013**, deals with workplace harassment and institutional redressal. Neither statute eliminates risks merely by existing. Registered offences measure reporting as well as incidence; rising case counts cannot be interpreted without context.

Telangana illustration. Hyderabad's growing commuter, platform and professional work environments demand functioning workplace committees, safe last-mile transport, digital reporting options and protection against retaliation. Such settings should be analysed without alleging unverified crimes at particular institutions.

Response. Effective policy requires rapid healthcare, trauma-informed evidence collection, credible policing, legal aid, independent workplace processes, economic options and prevention in schools and communities. Measure response time, protection compliance, repeat harm and survivor access to remedies.

Conclusion. Equality demands a shift from **formal protective provisions to usable safety, voice and economic autonomy**. Survivor-centred implementation is the true measure of policy effectiveness.

Question 5. Is regionalism a threat to national integration? Answer with reference to Telangana.

Thesis. Regionalism can either improve democratic representation or undermine equal citizenship; its character depends on the demands, methods and institutional response.

Arguments. Unequal distribution of jobs, irrigation, education and expenditure may create legitimate territorial grievances. Linguistic and cultural recognition also matters because citizenship includes voice and dignity. Telangana's trajectory—from the **1956 Gentlemen's Agreement**, through the **1969 agitation**, subsequent mobilisation and the **Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014**—illustrates the constitutional accommodation of regional demands. Formation on **2 June 2014** was a political-institutional response, not a guarantee that economic disparities disappeared. Hyderabad's concentration of investment and services presents a continuing internal regional-balancing challenge.

Critical distinction. A movement for transparent safeguards or new statehood is not inherently anti-national. Regionalism becomes exclusionary when it denies other citizens freedom of movement, equal law enforcement or livelihood opportunities. Administrative boundaries cannot replace evidence-led distribution of public resources.

Way forward. Strengthen state and local fiscal accountability, publish district-level outcomes, create fair recruitment systems, cooperate on shared water resources and develop secondary urban centres. Evaluate not only allocations but timely execution and service access.

Conclusion. Well-governed federalism transforms regional claims into negotiation and accountability. National integration is strongest when regional dignity and **constitutional equality for every resident** advance together.

Question 6. Development-induced displacement reveals a gap between project benefits and social costs. Examine.

Introduction. Infrastructure and resource development may generate widespread benefits while imposing concentrated losses on families whose homes, land, work or common resources are affected.

Conceptual distinction. Physical displacement is relocation of residence; economic displacement may arise from lost farms, grazing, fishing, market access or informal businesses even without relocation. Michael Cernea's impoverishment-risks model identifies landlessness, joblessness, homelessness, marginalisation, food insecurity, morbidity, common-resource loss and social disarticulation. A one-time land cheque cannot automatically restore these networks.

Legal framework. The **2013 land acquisition, rehabilitation and resettlement statute** introduced procedures including social-impact assessment and rehabilitation/resettlement in cases it governs. Project-specific regimes, applicable amendments and exceptions must be separately checked. An entitlement list built only around registered owners may overlook tenants, sharecroppers and informal wage earners.

Telangana application. Large irrigation and metropolitan transport projects should be examined through transparent affected-household surveys, village services, livelihood opportunities and the fate of common resources; avoid invented project displacement totals.

Reform agenda. Identify all categories of affected people before approval, disclose alternatives, provide grievance hearings, guarantee replacement housing and basic services, protect cultural sites, and monitor livelihoods for years after resettlement.

Conclusion. A development project is genuinely inclusive when **the people bearing its costs can recover their capabilities**, rather than merely receiving nominal compensation.

Question 7. Examine the interconnected nature of agrarian distress, agricultural labour insecurity and migration.

Introduction. Agrarian distress is a livelihood-system problem. Crop failure is one trigger, but unstable prices, rising input costs, fragmented holdings, tenancy and credit terms may also erode net farm income.

Causal chain. Rainfall uncertainty and pest damage lower yield, while market swings can reduce prices even after a good harvest. Debt becomes distressing when repayments exceed feasible earnings. Farm labourers face seasonal demand, low bargaining power and exposure to heat and chemicals; their conditions may worsen even if crop output rises. When local work disappears, households may send members to construction or services in Hyderabad or elsewhere, retaining a circular link with the village. Migration can diversify earnings but also exposes workers to contractor dependence, insecure housing and children's interrupted schooling.

Distinct Telangana examples. Cotton-growing areas face production and market uncertainties, while paddy cultivation raises irrigation and energy questions. Migrant construction settlements near expanding urban corridors may need portable food entitlements, wage redressal and school continuity.

Policy package. Integrate protective irrigation, transparent procurement, timely crop insurance, tenant-sensitive credit, quality local nonfarm jobs, wage enforcement and the **current VB–G RAM G Act 2025 rural-household guarantee (125 days since 1 July 2026)**; cite MGNREGA's 100-day guarantee only as historical context. Measure real net farm income, days of paid labour, indebtedness, migrant wage retention and children's attendance.

Conclusion. The solution is not to prevent mobility, but to make **farming viable, farm labour dignified and migration a choice rather than desperation**.

Question 8. Sustainable urbanisation requires environmental justice and metropolitan coordination. Discuss with Hyderabad.

Opening. Cities generate jobs and productivity through agglomeration, but unplanned expansion can place environmental and housing costs disproportionately on low-income residents.

Hyderabad's spatial evidence. The older city around Charminar, Secunderabad, industrial corridors and western IT clusters grew through different political and economic phases. ORR enhances orbital connectivity but can encourage peri-urban conversion. Metro rail improves movement on selected corridors, but accessibility depends on safe walking, bus feeders, transfers and fares. The **Musi basin** connects urban sewage, lake systems, impervious surfaces and flood risk; one jurisdiction cannot manage the catchment in isolation.

Institutional dimension. GHMC has municipal service functions while **HMDA** works across a wider metropolitan-planning area. Published Master Planning **2031** materials are planning instruments, not proof that all proposed infrastructure has been built. Informal tenants, migrant households and workers at exposed outdoor sites need recognition in service data and heat/flood preparedness.

Way forward. Join land-use rules, catchment restoration, wastewater treatment, affordable rental housing, inclusive transit and transparent development permissions. Track neighbourhood air and water quality, commute time, flood exposure and rent burdens, not just kilometres of road or Metro.

Conclusion. A sustainable metropolis is not simply larger or richer; it **coordinates growth with ecological limits and equal access to essential urban capabilities**.

Model-answer self-audit

A high-scoring answer should contain: (i) an issue-specific definition, (ii) at least three distinct causes or mechanisms, (iii) a named legal or analytical concept, (iv) an accurate Telangana case where relevant, (v) one counterargument or limitation, and (vi) a practicable evaluative conclusion. Avoid generic paragraphs repeated across unrelated questions.

Part G — Dated current affairs

Topic-linked current developments (dated and carefully qualified)

1. Telangana Socio-Economic Outlook 2026

The Telangana State Portal lists a **2026 Socio-Economic Outlook** in its annual reports catalogue. It can be used for updated sector, labour, social development, urbanisation and farming context. **Do not insert unverifiable district rates from memory**; the detailed report's measure and year must be checked before using a number. This is an official source, not proof that every desired indicator was measured in 2026.

2. Periodic Labour Force Survey: 2025 annual and 2026 monthly publications

MoSPI published the **Annual PLFS 2025 report in 2026** and monthly CWS tables for the 2026 reference period. The September 2026 MoSPI dashboard reports the all-India **CWS unemployment rate for persons aged 15+ as 5.0%**. This is **not** the Telangana rate, not a 2025 annual usual-status estimate, and not a youth-specific rate. These definitions matter in mains answers on educated unemployment and labour-market distress.

3. Poverty indicator and dated projection

NITI Aayog's **15 January 2024** discussion paper estimated India's multidimensional poverty headcount at **11.28% for 2022–23**. Its projected nature and the MPI's weighting are essential qualifying facts. There is no basis to present this as a direct enumeration of 2026 income poverty or as a complete explanation of inequality.

4. Child labour and rights-based governance

The Labour Ministry's official text of the **Child and Adolescent Labour Act**, reflecting the **2016 amendment**, is the controlling examination reference for general prohibitions and limited exemptions. It should be read with the RTE framework, rather than assuming educational enrollment automatically establishes a child's safety.

5. Development and displacement law

The official text of the **2013 land acquisition, rehabilitation and resettlement law** details objections, hearings and resettlement procedures for covered acquisitions. The exact regime and applicable state changes must be checked for a real project; the presence of an Act is not proof of successful rehabilitation.

Part H — Source register and limits

Internal source verification register — not student-facing

Status: FACTUAL EDITORIAL REVIEW STILL REQUIRED. Core official sources consulted as of 22 October 2026:

- Exact syllabus TGPSC Group-I Notification 02/2024 Annexure II, PDF page index 29: https://websitenew.tgpsc.gov.in/preview/RElSRUNUUkVDUlVJVE1FTlROT1RJL05PVElGSUNBVElPTl9OT18wMi0yMDI0X0dyb3VwLUlfU2VydmljZXMgKDEpMjAyNDAyMjAxNDA3MzcucGRmr95v17a0y2d8i13v
- Official main exam 200-word pattern https://websitenew.tspsc.gov.in/preview/UFJFU1NOT1RFL0dyb3VwIDEtIE1haW4gRXhhbS1RdWVzdGlvbiBQYXR0ZXJuMjAyMzAxMTgyMDQ4NTIucGRmr95v17a0y2d8i13v
- MoSPI Annual PLFS 2025 https://mospi.gov.in/uploads/publications_reports/publications_reports1780040415321_0624fb13-fb47-40bc-b470-7c7e9635c3ef_PLFS_2025_F_REV_29052026.pdf
- MoSPI PLFS 2026 dashboard https://www.mospi.gov.in/themes/product/69--
- Telangana SEO 2026 report catalogue https://www.telangana.gov.in/reports/
- NITI Aayog MPI discussion published 2024 https://www.pib.gov.in/Pressreleaseshare.aspx?PRID=1996271&lang=2&reg=48
- MGNREGA 2005 historical text (repealed 1 July 2026) https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/4649/1/a2005-42.pdf
- VB–G RAM G Act 2025, Act 36 of 2025 https://www.indiacode.nic.in/indiacode/handle/123456789/22478?view_type=browse
- MoRD/PIB 11 May 2026 commencement and repeal https://www.dord.gov.in/static/uploads/2026/05/6c0a4feea975932109261916ea1fc699.pdf
- Child and Adolescent Labour Act Labour Ministry https://www.labour.gov.in/static/uploads/2025/06/2e8a5a3a8a785a9a96569af94290aee7.pdf
- 2013 LARR official statute https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/2121/1/A2013-30.pdf
- Relevant conceptual books NCERT Indian Society; NCERT Social Change and Development in India; Sen Development as Freedom; Dreze and Sen An Uncertain Glory; M.N. Srinivas Social Change in Modern India; Cernea on impoverishment risks.

Do NOT silently promote unverified original questions to PYQs. Verify contemporary rates with release date, geography, age range, status definition and numerator/denominator; claim-level review remains incomplete.

Cycle 103 directly checked source correspondences

Source	Checked scope	Explicit limitation
NITI Aayog discussion paper (January 2024)	11.28% projected national MPI for 2022–23	Not 2026 census or Telangana rate
Directorate General of Employment, PLFS 2023–24 catalogue (10 October 2024)	Report identity and labour-indicator denominator reasoning	Not a full PLFS table audit
Ministry of Labour and Employment, Child Labour Act and 2016 amendment	Child/adolescent statutory categories and qualified exceptions	Not a complete case-law review
Telangana State Profile	State formation chronology 1956/2014	No district outcome audit
India Code: VB–G RAM G Act 2025 and MoRD/PIB commencement notice, 11 May 2026	125-day eligible rural-household guarantee from 1 July 2026, replacing the repealed MGNREGA 100-day law	Not proof of delivered workdays, wage timeliness or transition quality
Indian Economic Service urban classification	Census-town classification thresholds	Not 2026 town counts
UN 2030 Agenda	Three integrated sustainable-development dimensions	Not project success evidence
MoSPI Time Use Survey 2024 factsheet (25 February 2025)	Q18: 81.5% female / 27.1% male all-India unpaid domestic-service participation, persons 6+	Survey-day participation, not hours or Telangana-specific rates; no microdata reanalysis
Legislative Department, Constitution Part III, Articles 23–24	Q21: trafficking, begar, forced labour versus under-14 hazardous employment	Constitutional text only; no case-law or state enforcement audit
Census of India 2011 rural–urban definition	Q26: census-town population, density, male main-worker thresholds	2011 classification rules, not evidence of 2026 settlement status

Cycle104 editorial note (30 October 2026): Replaced three substantially overlapping MCQs (18, 21, 26) with differentiated official-source-correlated questions; repaired inline option formatting in Q2 and Q6. This is an author-side five-item review, NOT independent verification of all 30 keys and 90 distractors.

Academic status: Claim-level review, official syllabus authentication, browser accessibility and named independent expert review remain outstanding; approvals ZERO.

Cycle105 source-critical correction (30 October 2026): The 2005 MGNREGA 100-day entitlement was repealed effective 1 July 2026 and replaced by the 2025 VB–G RAM G Act with a 125-day **rural-household** guarantee, as announced by the Ministry of Rural Development on 11 May 2026. Q10 and affected chapter/mains/source-register statements were updated. Twelve other MCQs had their existing option texts **reordered only** (five B→A, seven B→D) to remove severe key-position bias; no correct answer proposition or distractor proposition was changed. This is an author-side correction, not independent 30-key/90-distractor verification, not official PYQ authentication and not R1–R8 approval.